

Weekly Self-Study Tasks to Complete

Phase 1 — Week 7: GitHub Actions and CI/CD Pipelines for Leaders

This document covers all of Week 7 in the 4-hour Leaders model: 2 hours of instructor-led session, 1 hour of self-study video, and 1 hour of hands-on lab. The Core Resources table below fits inside the 1-hour self-study media budget. The Practice Activities section points to the Evergreen Insurance Quote Page — CI Check lab, where you add a minimal GitHub Actions workflow to your Week 2 repository and watch a real run. Additional Content at the end is optional and sits outside the 4-hour budget. This week's goal is fluency reading an Actions run, not authoring sophisticated pipelines.

Core Resources (~60 min)

The week's single core video is Aaron Stewart's "GitHub Actions: The Big Picture," which mirrors the instructor session closely. Treat it as reinforcement rather than new material — you should finish it able to point at any block in a workflow file and say what it does. Every link and duration below has been verified against the source platform.

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
GitHub Actions	GitHub Actions: The Big Picture (Aaron Stewart, Pluralsight, updated Jun 6, 2024) — watch the full course. Four modules that answer what GitHub Actions is, what a workflow looks like, how to read a run, and how Actions fits alongside the rest of GitHub. Concept-first — no YAML authoring drills. A close mirror of this week's session, so use it to lock in the vocabulary rather than to learn something brand new.	~42 min	pluralsight.com — GitHub Actions: The Big Picture

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
Slide Skim	Review the week's slide deck at a high level. Confirm you recognize the terms workflow, job, step, runner, action, artifact, environment, and secret. Re-open the sample workflow file from the lab and say out loud what each block does. Skim only — this is a vocabulary check, not a second pass through the deck.	~15 min	See course material

Practice Activities (1 hour)

Complete this week's hands-on lab: "Evergreen Insurance Quote Page — CI Check." You will add a single `.github/workflows/ci.yml` file to the `evergreen-quote-demo` repository you created in Week 2, open a pull request with that change, and read the resulting Actions run in the GitHub UI. The application itself does not change. The whole workflow takes about one hour.

In the lab you will:

- Create a feature branch `add-ci-check` in your Week 2 `evergreen-quote-demo` repository (or catch up using the Labfiles copy).
- Add `.github/workflows/ci.yml` with a minimal workflow: one job, three steps (checkout, setup-node, `node --check app.js`).
- Commit and push the branch, then open a pull request against `main`.
- Watch the run in the Checks tab of the PR. Click into Details and expand each step to see the log output.
- Intentionally break `app.js` (delete a closing brace), push, and read the failing run log. Revert to return to green.
- Self-review the Files changed tab, Approve, Squash-and-merge, and delete the branch.
- `git checkout main && git pull` to confirm the merge landed and the green check sits on the latest commit.

The lab instructions (with "Why this matters" callouts throughout) are in the lab environment. Budget one hour and work at your own pace.

Additional Content (Optional)

The following resources are optional and recommended for leaders who want to go deeper beyond the core curriculum. They sit outside the 4-hour weekly budget. None of these are required — you can absolutely stop at the Pluralsight course and the lab and have everything you need for the rest of Phase 1.

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
GitHub Actions (Video)	Learning GitHub Actions: Event-Driven Automation for Your Codebase — Michael Jenkins (LinkedIn Learning, Sep 15, 2025). 2h 9m. Covers workflow creation, event triggers, CI/CD patterns, and custom actions. A deeper follow-up to the Pluralsight course for leaders who want to see the authoring side of what their engineers do every day (Video Course)	linkedin.com/learning — Learning GitHub Actions (2025)
GitHub Docs	Understanding GitHub Actions — GitHub Docs. The official one-page explanation of workflows, events, jobs, actions, and runners. 10-minute read. Use it as a vocabulary reference rather than a tutorial (Reference)	docs.github.com — Understanding GitHub Actions
Quickstart	Quickstart for GitHub Actions — GitHub Docs. A ten-minute walk through creating your first workflow from the GitHub web UI. Worth skimming if you want to see the “suggested workflows” experience a developer is offered when they click the Actions tab on an empty repo (Reference)	docs.github.com — Quickstart
Marketplace	GitHub Marketplace — Actions. The public catalog of reusable actions your teams pull from when they write	github.com/marketplace — Actions

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
	workflows. Spend five minutes browsing the categories (testing, deployment, utilities) so you understand the breadth of what your engineers can snap into a pipeline without writing from scratch (Reference)	
Skills (Hands-on)	GitHub Skills. Free, guided, in-repo exercises that walk through GitHub features including Actions. The “Hello GitHub Actions” course is the lightest-weight hands-on introduction to authoring a workflow and is fully self-paced (Hands-on Tutorial)	skills.github.com
Reference	Workflow syntax for GitHub Actions — GitHub Docs. The canonical reference for every key you can put in a workflow file (on, jobs, steps, runs-on, uses, with, env, if, matrix, needs, and so on). Not for cover-to-cover reading — bookmark it and open it whenever you need to decode a workflow file someone has shared with you (Reference)	docs.github.com — Workflow syntax